

Nipple problems Women who have flat nipples that do not protrude or whose nipples are inverted may worry that they may not be able to breastfeed. All healthy women can breastfeed because babies feed by taking in a mouthful of breast, not just the nipple.

Causes Inverted or flat nipples are thought to be due to shorter ligaments in the underlying breast tissue that pull the nipples inward.

What to do If you have any concerns about the suitability of your nipples for breastfeeding, talk to your doctor who can refer you to a lactation consultant. There are also products available that will draw out nipples in preparation for breastfeeding. However, these are by no means essential because when babies latch on to the breast they are able to draw out even a flat or inverted nipple (although you may need a lactation consultant to show you the best way to help your baby do this).

Digestive problems

Nausea and vomiting Approximately 80 percent of women are troubled by the unpleasant symptoms of nausea and vomiting in early pregnancy. This usually subsides between 12 and 20 weeks; however, it's not uncommon to experience some return of these problems late in the pregnancy.

Causes In the first trimester, pregnancy hormones interact with hormones that control other body systems, particularly those involved with blood sugar regulation, and this results in feelings of nausea and vomiting. Late in pregnancy, problems with digestion may occur because the uterus takes up most of the space in the abdomen, displacing your intestines and stomach and leaving little room for the digestion of large amounts of food.

What to do Drink plenty of water throughout the day and eat small amounts of food on a regular basis, which will help to avoid long gaps between meals, and snacking on complex carbohydrates such as whole wheat and whole grain products. Avoid snacks with a high sugar content because, although these will give you a quick boost, they will soon leave you feeling worse than before because your blood sugar will plummet. Reducing your overall intake of the refined sugar found in candy, cake, cookies, and sugary drinks will help reduce the symptoms of nausea and vomiting and will also lessen your risk of developing gestational diabetes.

Gastroenteritis This is inflammation of the lining of the stomach and intestines, most commonly due to infection. It causes vomiting and diarrhea that usually come on suddenly. In most cases, the condition clears up on its own. However, if it's severe, you could become dehydrated, and this can affect blood flow to your baby through the placenta. Infection with listeria bacteria can, rarely, cause late miscarriage.

Causes Gastroenteritis is caused by infection contracted either through contact with an infected person or by food poisoning.

What to do Drink plenty of water, and try to avoid cross infection with other members of the household. If you're unable to retain even small sips of water, or your vomiting and diarrhea have lasted for 24 hours, seek medical advice from your doctor. If you can't reach your doctor, go to the nearest hospital emergency room for treatment. If you have a preexisting medical condition, such as diabetes, seek help immediately. You may be treated with intravenous fluids if you are dehydrated, and fetal monitoring may be carried out. Infection with listeria is treated with antibiotics.

Avoiding gastroenteritis Practice good food hygiene (see [Dietary precautions](#)). If someone else in your household has gastroenteritis, avoid infection by using separate soap, towels, cutlery, and dishes. If you have more than one bathroom, get the infected person to use a separate one. Wipe toilets, sinks, and faucets with a mild bleach solution after each use. Infected individuals should also avoid preparing food for others.

Indigestion and heartburn are common during the second trimester.